

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 2
 ♥ K 8 2
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣K which you win with dummy's ♣A.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 4

You could come to your hand with the ♦A and finesse East for the ♥K. The problem with this idea is that even if the finesse works the ♥K probably wouldn't drop.

A better idea is to stay away from trumps until you ruff a ♦ loser in dummy. So you play the ♦K and everybody follows with small cards. Then play the ♦8, covered by West's ♦J, taken by your ♦A.

Next play your ♦3. West plays the ♦Q and you do what?

You ruff of course, that was the whole point of playing ♦s before trumps. But which card will you ruff with? Suppose you ruff with the ♥5 and West follows with another ♦. You could then play ♠A and ruff a ♠ to get to your hand, then ruff your last ♦ with dummy's ♥A. You would lose only the trump King and one ♣, making an overtrick.

Any problem with that? Yes, a big problem. West might be out of ♦s also. If you ruff with dummy's ♥5 West may overruff, then play a trump and you would not get any ♦ ruffs. Since you only need to ruff one ♦ in dummy to make the contract, it is safer to ruff with the ♥A. You will end up losing 1 ♣, 1 ♦ and the trump King.

Ruffing with the ♥A was the safe way to play the hand, and with this layout the only way to succeed.

Did you notice that East is a pretty good defender? Playing the ♦Q on the third round just might have convinced you that he was short in ♦s, in which case ruffing with the low trump would have been safe.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4
 ♥ A K 10 4 2
 ♦ J 6 4 2
 ♣ Q 9

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2



♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5

♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
on of your ♣ winners.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ A, then the ♥ K, then ♥ 10.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

The 2 ♥s are already lost, so you put your mind to the 2 ♣s. If the suit splits 3-3 the problem goes away, but a 4-2 split is more likely. So you should plan to ruff the fourth ♣ in dummy.

Ruff the third ♥. Then play ♣ A K 3. West discards a ♥ on the third ♣ which East wins. East will probably return his last ♣ at this point, hoping West can ruff higher than dummy's ♠ 9. But he cannot, so you ruff in dummy, pull trumps and claim the rest.

This was a good plan, pretty much guaranteed to work unless the ♣s split 5-1 so that somebody ruffed

But, it was a good plan because dummy held the ♠ 9. Keep that in mind when you look at Deal 15.